

Progressive Wage Model

Companies must meet the PWM requirements for retail workers who are Singapore citizens or permanent residents.

Would you like a quick tour of our new page design?

Click **Next** to start.

Skip

Next

Who it covers

Companies must meet the PWM requirements for retail workers who are Singapore citizens or permanent residents.

What is it

The **Progressive Wage Model** (PWM) for retail workers was developed by the Tripartite Cluster for Retail Industry (TCR). It features:

- **Training requirements** that tap on the **Skills Framework for Retail** [\[1\]](#). This ensures that workers have the skills they need to carry out their jobs.
- **Progressive wages set at each level**. This ensures that workers are paid wages that correspond to their skills and productivity.

Employers **must meet the PWM requirements** to renew existing work passes or apply for new work passes.

Click [here](#) [\[2\]](#) for an overview of the Retail PWM.

Who it covers

The PWM requirements are mandatory. They cover all Singapore citizens and permanent residents who fulfil both of the following conditions:

- Employed as full-time or part-time employees in retail job roles on a contract of service.
- Employed by firms which hire foreign workers, regardless of whether the firm is classified under the Retail Trade Singapore Standard Industrial Classification (SSIC) or another SSIC.

The retail PWM will cover the following retail job roles:

Retail manager

Responsibilities:

- Oversee end-to-end operations
- Ensure Standard Operating Procedures are followed
- Make decisions on customers' issues and service recovery
- Drive, analyse, improve and achieve sales and service performance
- Drive seamless customer experience across offline and online channels
- Evaluate and propose training needs for staff to meet market and customers' needs

Retail supervisor

Responsibilities:

- Supervises retail staff to provide customer service
- Ensure operational demands are catered for
- Possess strong product and customer service knowledge
- Conduct trainings for roles in the store
- Perform responsibilities of an assistant retail supervisor

Assistant retail supervisor

Responsibilities:

- Assist the retail supervisor to oversee the daily store operations
- Achieve store's sales target and maximise profitability
- Prepare monthly roster of the sales team
- Supervise, coach, counsel and coordinate the activities of retail assistants, cashiers and third-party staff

Senior cashier

Responsibilities:

- Mentor and guide the work execution of other cashiers
- Plan resources to support smooth operation in the checkout department
- Deliver training materials and conduct on-job-training for new cashiers
- Ensure daily bank-in of monies and be responsible for cash variance analysis and reports
- Perform responsibilities of a cashier

Senior retail assistant

Responsibilities:

- Assist the retail supervisor or manager in inventory management
- Mentor and guide the work execution of other retail assistants
- Handle customer enquiries on promotions and leading customer to products
- Conduct on-job-training for new retail assistants
- Perform responsibilities of a retail assistant

 Find & Summarise

Cashier

Responsibilities:

- Assist customers in the in-store checkout process
- Process and fulfil online orders if required
- Implement current promotional events during the checkout process
- Provide customer service, such as attending to customers' queries or assisting in customer exchange and refunds

Retail assistant

Responsibilities:

- Sell and explain the functions and qualities of products
- Assist customers by pointing out or demonstrating features and merits of products
- Manage and maintain store display standards and arrangement of products
- Stock-take and replenish stock according to company's Standard Operating Procedures
- Keep up to date with the product features, promotions and trends and participate in training to improve product knowledge and service quality

Note

Companies may adopt different job titles, such as "Shop / Sales Assistant / Associate"

Tip

If you need help with identifying your PWM job classification, you may use our [PWM self-assessment tool](#) .

Wage requirements

Wage requirements for **part-time employees** are pro-rated on a 44-hours basis.

The TCR will undertake a review of the wage schedule in 2026.

Job level	Monthly gross wage requirements (excluding overtime payments) for full-time retail workers (35-44 hours per week)			
	1 Sep 2024 - 31 Aug 2025	1 Sep 2025 - 31 Aug 2026	1 Sep 2026 - 31 Aug 2027	1 Sep 2027 - 31 Aug 2028
Retail manager  Retail supervisor	Left to market forces			
 Assistant retail supervisor	≥ \$2,635	≥ \$2,790	≥ \$2,950	≥ \$3,100
 Senior cashier / Senior retail assistant	≥ \$2,395	≥ \$2,535	≥ \$2,680	≥ \$2,820
 Retail assistant / Cashier	≥ \$2,175	≥ \$2,305	≥ \$2,435	≥ \$2,565

 Find & Summarise

Note

Total monthly gross wage (for full-time work of 35-44 hours per week) refers to the sum of:

- Basic wage
- Allowances such as travel, food, and housing
- Productivity incentive payments

It does not include:

- Bonuses including Annual Wage Supplement
- Stock options
- Reimbursement of special expenses incurred in the course of employment
- Payments-in-kind
- Employer CPF contributions

Additional PWM gross wage requirements for overtime

Employers must meet additional requirements for full-time employees who **fulfil both of the following conditions**:

- work more than 44 hours a week.
- are covered by Part 4 of the **Employment Act**.

Employers must pay these employees according to **both of the following conditions**:

- **An overtime rate of pay at least 1.5 times the basic rate of pay**, according to overtime requirements under Part 4 of the Employment Act.
- **A monthly gross wage of at least the PWM gross wage requirements for overtime hours before 1 September 2025 and from 1 September 2025**  .

Tip

Averaging of gross wages

Because the retail sector sees seasonal fluctuations in sales revenue throughout the year, the TCR has agreed for the averaging of the wage requirements for retail employees covered by the retail PWM over a 3-month period.

For a given month, employers must fulfil **either one of these conditions**:

- The gross wage paid for that month is at least that month's wage requirements (inclusive of OT pay, if any).
- The past 3 months' average gross wage is at least the average of past 3 months' wage requirements (inclusive of OT pay, if any).

More details and worked examples are in [Annex D of the TCR's report](#) .

Training requirements

Employers must ensure that their Singapore citizen and permanent resident retail workers meet the following training requirements:

- **All Retail PWM job roles:** 1 Workforce Skills Qualification (WSQ) module from the list of approved modules or relevant Institute of Higher Learning (IHL) qualification conferred by MOE-registered educational institutions.
- **If employer has attained in-house approved training organisation (ATO) status:** 1 in-house WSQ training module with prefix "RET" in the Technical Skills & Competencies (TSC) code can be used to meet training requirements as well.

Employers will be given a grace period to comply with the training requirements:

- For new hires: six months from the new hire's date of employment.

 [Find & Summarise](#)

Through proper training, retail workers will be able to increase their productivity and offer good retail experiences to customers.

More details on training requirements are found in [Annex C of the TCR's report](#) .

Find out more

For more information:

- [TCR's report and recommendations issued in 2025](#) 
- [TCR's report and recommendations issued in 2022](#) 



Related questions

[My business operates a retail front that sells a variety of food items, how should I pay my employees?](#)

[Are petrol attendants covered under the PWM for retail sector?](#)

[Can retail-related tertiary-level certification count towards retail PWM training?](#)

[How do I pay my retail employees who perform overtime work according to PWM requirements?](#)

[The Tripartite Cluster for Retail report recommended that the wages of local retail supervisors and retail managers be left to market forces. What does leaving wages to market forces mean? Do training requirements apply to these employees?](#)



Find & Summarise